

Cloud Scripts

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Figure 1: Installation view of Cloud Scripts, 2024.

Abstract

Cloud Scripts is a generative art installation, and a conceptual machine that explores the asemic nature of Daoist Cloud Seals as a form of communication between humans and the spiritual world. By extracting a corpus of ‘Cloud Seals’ from Daoist scriptures and training trained on a fine tuned Gen Ai model, the installation generates a series of talismans. These talismans, devoid of specific pictorial meaning, symbolize my desire to engage in a dialogue with the spiritual world. The data and software I create serve as my letter to the spiritual realm, expressed through machines.

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SA Art Gallery '25, Hong Kong, Hong Kong
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ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1883-0/25/12
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3757368.3765544>

CCS Concepts

• Applied computing → Media arts.

Keywords

Generative Art, Visualization for Culture/Cultural Heritage, Installation, Cosmotronics

ACM Reference Format:

Kian Peng Ong. 2025. Cloud Scripts. In *SIGGRAPH Asia 2025 Art Gallery (SA Art Gallery '25)*, December 15–18, 2025, Hong Kong, Hong Kong. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757368.3765544>

1 Introduction

In *Two Texts on Technology*, Kiyoshi Miki critiques how modern mechanical machines have severed the once-intimate relationship between humans and tools. He contrasts this with Eastern technological traditions, which emphasize the cultivation of spirit and humanity. Miki calls for a return to these traditions as a resistance against the alienation and environmental degradation caused by Western, efficiency-driven technology [Miki et al. 2021]. This philosophical backdrop inspires a deeper inquiry into alternative

technological futures: What if machines could reconnect us with the spiritual and ecological world, rather than alienate us from it?

This question drives the development of *Cloud Scripts*, a generative art installation and conceptual machine. The project explores how machines—usually understood as tools of utility, speed, and productivity—might instead serve as mediators between the human and the spiritual realms. Drawing from Daoist esoteric practices, where texts are viewed not merely as vessels of information but as sacred instructions for engaging with the divine, the installation reimagines the machine learning model itself as a form of spiritual text.

At the heart of *Cloud Scripts* are Cloud Seals, a visual script inspired by cloud formations and used in pre-Han Daoist traditions to communicate with the spirit world. The installation extracts a corpus of these sacred forms from Daoist scriptures and feeds them into a custom-trained machine learning model. This model, functioning as an interpretive and generative oracle, produces asemic talismans, forms devoid of specific pictorial meaning—serving as symbolic messages to the spiritual world.

Functionally, *Cloud Scripts* is a software-driven system that visualizes generated seals as outputs, but conceptually it questions dominant narratives around technology's purpose. The outcome is a body of generated spiritual forms, statistically derived yet ritually resonant, where the machine learning model itself becomes a sacred mediator between code, spirit, and intention.



Figure 2: Interface display of Cloud Scripts. A new talisman is generated every 15 minutes

2 Artist Statement

Cloud Scripts extends my ongoing research into the philosophical and scientific implications of modernity on the ecological crisis we face today. Central to this inquiry is a critique of the dominant notion that progress and the future follow a singular, linear trajectory—a belief that has contributed to our current environmental and existential dilemmas. Drawing on Yuk Hui's concept of Cosmotechnics [Hui 2020], which challenges the Western narrative of technology as a universal and capitalist-driven path, this work explores alternative ways of becoming. In response to the theme "Generative Futures: Continuous Becoming," *Cloud Scripts*

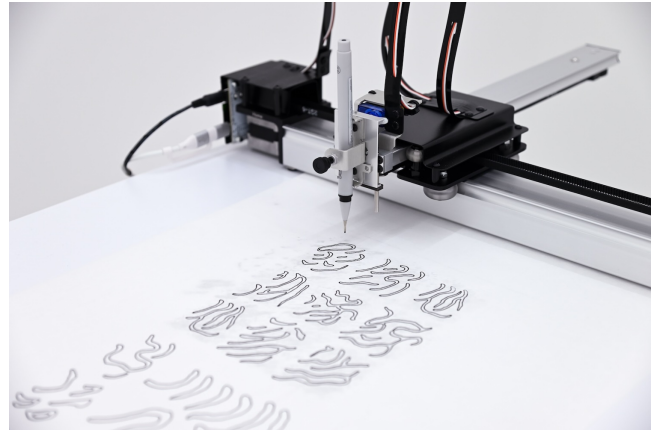


Figure 3: Installation close-up shot featuring the plotter

proposes that technological futures can emerge from plural cosmologies, rooted in spiritual, ecological, and cultural contexts. By reintegrating cosmological thinking into the language of machines, the work reimagines technology not as a tool of control or acceleration, but as a potential mediator between humans and the cosmos. *Cloud Scripts* thus invites reflection on how we might cultivate futures shaped not by domination, but by resonance, ritual, and relationality. This critical application of philosophical inquiry is central to my practice—not merely as content, but as a framework through which the entanglements between technology, culture, and the environment are explored.

References

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- Kiyoshi Miki, Norihito Nakamura, and Wirtz Fernando. 2021. Two Texts on Technology The Ideal of Technology, Technology and the New Culture. *European Journal of Japanese Philosophy* 6, 2 (2021), 323–351. <https://ejjp-journal.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/12/ejpp-6-11-nakamura-and-wirtz.pdf>